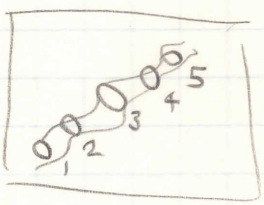
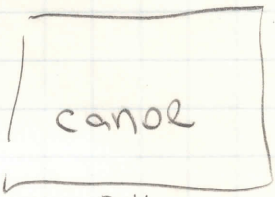
(4) When the early settlers arrived the river was wild ~~with~~ and ~~unnavigable~~ difficult to navigate with ..... rapids between Montreal & Lake Ontario
(what is now known as)



(5) ~~Under the French regime~~ The river has played an increasingly important commercial role leading to the evolution of 4 canal systems since 1779

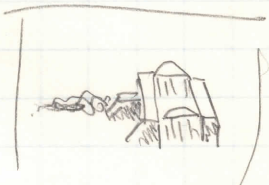
~~To bypass these rapids locks connected~~ in some cases

(6) The river started to play an increasingly commercial and military role ~~but~~ and as ~~the~~ boats increased in size rapids had to be overcome



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(7) ~~The~~ ~~project~~ ~~was~~ Beginning 1779 a start was made with the first canal system and completed in 1783 between Lake St. Louis and Lake St. Francis



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(8) However there were still many obstacles